WTO Ministerial Conferences

WORLD TRADE ORGANIZATION

12. Kazakhstan - 2020
11. Buenos Aires, 10-13 December 2017
10. Nairobi, 15-18 December 2015
09. Bali, 3-6 December 2013
08. Geneva, 15-17 December 2011
07. Geneva, 30 November - 2 December 2009
06. Hong Kong, 13-18 December 2005
05. Cancún, 10-14 September 2003
04. Doha, 9-13 November 2001
03. Seattle, November 30 – December 3 1999
02. Geneva, 18-20 May 1998
01. Singapore, 9-13 December 1996

8.4.4. WTO and India

India is the founding member of the WTO. India favours multilateral trade approach. It enjoys MFN status and allows the same status to all other trading partners. India benefited from WTO on following grounds:

1. By reducing tariff rates on raw materials, components and capital goods, it was able to import more for meeting her developmental requirements. India's imports go on increasing.
2. India gets market access in several countries without any bilateral trade agreements.
3. Advanced technology has been obtained at cheaper cost.
4. India is in a better position to get quick redressal from the trade disputes.
5. The Indian exporters benefited from wider market information.

8.5 Trade Blocks

LWARB

- Some countries create business opportunities for themselves by integrating their economies in order to avoid unnecessary competition among them. Trade blocks cover different kinds of arrangements between or among countries for mutual benefit. Economic integration takes the form of *Free Trade Area, Customs Union, Common Market and Economic Union.*
- **A free trade area** is the region encompassing a trade bloc whose member countries have signed a free-trade agreement (FTA). Such agreements involve cooperation between at least two countries to reduce trade barriers. e.g. SAFTA, EFTA.
- **A customs union** is defined as a type of trade block which is composed of a free trade area with no tariff among members and (zero tariffs among members) with a common external tariff. e.g. BENELUX (Belgium, Netherland and Luxumbuarg).
- **Common market** is established through trade pacts. A group formed by countries within a geographical

12-Economics-Chapter_8.indd 165 23-12-2022 14:45:01